Clashes between protesters and a section of the security forces intensified towards late November and Ershad's administration brutally censored the media. Ismail informed Dixit that besides the Awami League and the BNP, over a dozen political parties had launched agitations against Ershad's corrupt and illegal rule.

On 25 November 1990, Patwardhan and his team retreated into the shadows. Two days later, Ershad declared a state of emergency in the country and curfew was imposed across major cities. The next day, the carefully crafted espionage operation produced the much-awaited result. Students and political parties defied the curfew and though, many lives were lost in the coming days, the movement against Ershad continued. The dictator tried to divert the attention of the international community and on 2 December 1990 announced that parliamentary and presidential elections would be held early next year. When the news of Er-shad's latest move reached the team, the spies' immediate reaction was bouts of laughter. They knew Ershad would react again within twenty-four hours. And he did. On 4 December, about one lakh people marched through Dhaka in an unprecedented protest against Ershad, demanding that he step down with immediate effect. A few hours later, Ershad went on national television and announced his resignation. He also announced that parliament would decide on a caretaker government to run the country till the elections were held. Patwardhan and the rest of the team were jubilant though they could not set off firecrackers like the people on the streets.

A few days later, the Indian government came out with carefully drafted statement: